GOVERNMENT OF INDIA
MINISTRY OF CONSUMER AFFAIRS, FOOD & PUBLIC DISTRIBUTION
DEPARTMENT OF FOOD AND PUBLIC DISTRIBUTION

LOK SABHA
STARRED QUESTION NO.344
TO BE ANSWERED ON 22nd DECEMBER, 2021

ELIGIBLE HOUSEHOLDS UNDER NFSA

***344. SHRI JAYADEV GALLA:**

Will the Minister of CONSUMER AFFAIRS, FOOD AND PUBLIC DISTRIBUTION उपभोक्ता मामले, खाद्य और सार्वजनिक वितरण मंत्री **be pleased to state:**

(a) whether the Government has finalised the list of eligible households under the National Food Security Act (NFSA) taking into account COVID-19 pandemic and lockdown of the economy, if so, the details thereof and if not, the reasons therefor;

(b) the number of vigilance committees that have been set up under Section 29 of NFSA, State-wise;

(c) whether the Government has plans to introduce checks on Fair Price Shops to curb irregularities in the distribution of items and if so, the details thereof;

(d) whether the Government plans to introduce Food Stamp Scheme to overcome the flaws in the current procedure/structure of Public Distribution System (PDS); and

(e) if so, the details thereof and if not, the reasons therefor?

A N S W E R
MINISTER OF COMMERCE & INDUSTRY, CONSUMER AFFAIRS, FOOD & PUBLIC DISTRIBUTION AND TEXTILES
(SHRI PIYUSH GOYAL)

(a) to (e): A statement is laid on the Table of the House.

STATEMENT REFERRED TO IN REPLY TO PARTS (a) TO (e) OF THE STARRED QUESTION NO.344 DUE FOR ANSWER ON 22.12.2021 IN THE LOK SABHA.

(a): The National Food Security Act is operated under the joint responsibility of the Central and the State Governments. The responsibility of identification of eligible beneficiaries rests with the State Government as per the provisions of the Act. The identification of beneficiaries by States/Union Territories (UTs) is a continuous process, which involves exclusion of ineligible/ fake/ duplicate ration cards and also exclusion on account of death, migration etc. and inclusion on account of birth as also that of genuine left-out households. At present, about 79.69 crore beneficiaries are identified by the States/UTs under the Act.

In view of the outbreak of Covid-19, Central Government is allocating foodgrains to all the States/UTs under Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana (PM-GKAY), for distribution among beneficiaries covered under the National Food Security Act, 2013 (i.e. Antyodaya Anna Yojana and Priority Category Households). These households are entitled to receive 5 kg of foodgrains (rice / wheat) per person per month, free of cost. The entitlement of foodgrains under PM-GKAY is in addition to their entitlement under NFSA (i.e. 35 kg of foodgrains per month per AAY household and 5 kg of foodgrains per person per month for Priority Households @ Rs.3/2/1 per kg for rice/ wheat/ coarsegrains). The scheme was for the period April to November, 2020 and May to November, 2021. The scheme has now been extended till March, 2022. So far, under PMGKAY (Phase I to IV) Government has allocated almost 600 LMT foodgrains to States/UTs equivalent to Rs.2.07 Lakh crore in food subsidy.

As part of the Economic measures (Atma Nirbhar Bharat), allocation of foodgrains, free of cost, had been made to all the States/Union Territories, for the month of May and June, 2020, for stranded migrants who are not covered under the National Food Security Act, 2013 (NFSA) or any other State scheme PDS Cards. Such beneficiaries were eligible for 5 kg of foodgrains per person per month. Identification of such beneficiaries and distribution of foodgrains to them was the responsibility of concerned State Government or Union Territory Administration.

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Government of India in association with all States/Union Territories has started the implementation of nation-wide portability of the benefits under the NFSA i.e. the distribution of subsidized foodgrains to eligible households/ beneficiaries covered under NFSA, anywhere in the country through "One Nation One Ration Card (ONORC)" System by using the same/ existing ration card.

(b): Section 29 of the Act provides for constitution of Vigilance Committees at the State, District, Block and fair price shop levels for ensuring transparency and proper functioning of the Targeted Public Distribution System and accountability of the functionaries in such system. On the basis of information furnished by the State Governments/ UT Administrations, a statement indicating the details of State/UT-wise constitution of Vigilance Committees is at Annexure.

(c), (d)&(e): The Targeted Public Distribution System (TPDS) is operated under the joint responsibility of the Central and the State/Union Territory Governments wherein the operational responsibilities for implementation of TPDS including issue of licenses to fair price shop dealers, their control, regulation and monitoring within the State/UT rest with the State/UT Government concerned. Further, to keep a watch and curb irregularities in distribution of subsidized foodgrains is a regular process by all the States/UT Government for inquiry and appropriate action for resolving the issue at their end.

At present, no proposal to introduce Food Stamp Scheme is under consideration of the Government.

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ANNEXURE

ANNEXURE REFERRED TO IN PART (b) OF THE STARRED QUESTION NO. 344 DUE FOR ANSWER ON 22.12.2021 IN THE LOK SABHA.

S. No.	State/UT	Number of levels at which Vigilance Committees are constituted
1.	A&N Island	4 Level
2.	Andhra Pradesh	4 Level
3.	Arunachal Pradesh	4 Level
4.	Assam	4 Level
5.	Bihar	4 Level
6.	Chhattisgarh	4 Level
7.	DNH&DD	4 Level
8.	Gujarat	4 Level
9.	Haryana	4 Level
10.	Himachal Pradesh	4 Level
11.	Jharkhand	4 Level
12.	Karnataka	4 Level
13.	Kerala	4 Level
14.	Madhya Pradesh	4 Level
15.	Maharashtra	4 Level
16.	Manipur	4 Level
17.	Meghalaya	4 Level
18.	Mizoram	4 Level
19.	Nagaland	4 Level
20.	Odisha	4 Level
21.	Punjab	4 Level
22.	Sikkim	4 Level
23.	Tamil Nadu	4 Level
24.	Tripura	4 Level
25.	Uttarakhand	4 Level
26.	Uttar Pradesh	4 Level
27.	West Bengal	4 Level
28.	Delhi	3 Level
29.	Goa	3 Level
30.	Lakshadweep	2 Level
31.	Chandigarh	1 Level
32.	Rajasthan	1 Level
33.	Jammu & Kashmir	No Vigilance Committee is constituted.
34.	Ladakh	No Vigilance Committee is constituted.
35.	Puducherry	No Vigilance Committee is constituted.
36.	Telangana	No Vigilance Committee is constituted.

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